

POLICY ON SUSTAINABLE LAND USE AND RESTORATION

Rationale

The University of Mindanao recognizes the importance of sustainable land use and ecosystem restoration in achieving environmental balance, mitigating climate change, and conserving biodiversity. As an institution of higher learning, UM is committed to integrating sustainability principles into academic, research, and community engagement functions. This policy establishes a framework that ensures responsible stewardship of all university-managed terrestrial areas – including forestlands, agroforestry sites, and demonstration farms – while promoting education and research aligned with global and national environmental goals.

Scope

This policy applies to all UM campuses, field stations, and managed terrestrial areas such as the Agroforestry Demonstration Farm and Forestry Experimental Forest in Bayabas, Toril, Davao City. It encompasses activities related to land management, biodiversity conservation, research, restoration projects, and community-based resource management initiatives.

Guiding Principles

The policy is anchored on the following guiding principles:

Sustainability. Land resources shall be managed to maintain ecological integrity and productivity for present and future generations.

Conservation and Restoration. Degraded areas within university-managed lands shall be restored through reforestation, agroforestry, and soil and water conservation practices.

Education and Research Integration. All land-use activities shall serve as platforms for experiential learning and scientific inquiry.

Collaboration. Partnerships with government agencies, local communities, and stakeholders are encouraged to enhance restoration and conservation outcomes.

Accountability and Transparency. All activities under this policy shall be properly documented, monitored, and reported to uphold institutional accountability.

Policy Statement

The University of Mindanao is committed to promoting ecological balance and responsible stewardship of land resources. The university shall:

Maintain and restore degraded land and forest ecosystems within university-managed areas;
Implement sustainable land-use practices that integrate soil and water conservation, agroforestry, and biodiversity protection;

Utilize these areas as learning and research laboratories for students, faculty, and partner communities;

Collaborate with local government units, DENR, and other agencies for reforestation, watershed management, and conservation projects; and

Monitor and document ecological improvements and biodiversity indicators within managed lands.

Implementation and Review

The Institute of Biodiversity and Environment in coordination with the Environmental Studies Department, shall implement this policy. They are tasked to:

Supervise land-use planning, rehabilitation, and monitoring of UM-managed sites.

Ensure that research and field activities integrate sustainable land management practices.

Prepare annual reports on land condition, biodiversity indicators, and restoration outcomes for submission to the Research and Publication Center.

Conduct a policy review every three (3) years or as needed to ensure relevance to current environmental standards and institutional priorities.

Signed:

(Sgd) GUILLERMO P. TORRES, JR.
University President

References

Republic Act No. 7586 (NIPAS Act of 1992)
Republic Act No. 11038 (Expanded NIPAS Act of 2018)
UN Sustainable Development Goal 15: Life on Land